DOCUMENT GOVERNANCE POLICY

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1. Purpose

Define document authority, lifecycle, version control, supersession, and conflict-resolution rules for controlled enterprise documents.

2. Document hierarchy

When two controlled documents conflict on the same requirement and no explicit exception exists, the higher-authority document prevails.

Authority order	Document class	Interpretation
1 - Highest	Corporate Policy	Enterprise requirement approved at corporate policy level.
2	Standard	Mandatory control or technical/operating standard subordinate to policy.
3	Standard Operating Procedure (SOP)	Operational procedure describing how approved requirements are executed.
4 - Lowest	Work Instruction / Local Guide	Detailed local execution guidance.

3. Lifecycle status

Controlled documents may be active, superseded, or historical. Only active documents have current operational authority unless an active controlling document explicitly incorporates a historical requirement.

4. Supersession

When a new controlled version supersedes an older version, the older document remains available for audit and historical analysis but must not be used as the current operational instruction.

5. Conflict resolution

A current corporate policy prevails over a conflicting SOP. A current standard prevails over a conflicting SOP or work instruction. If two documents have the same authority level, effective date, explicit scope, and supersession relationships must be evaluated before escalation to the document owner.

6. Historical questions

Superseded documents may be used to answer questions about what rule applied during a historical period. Their historical relevance must not be interpreted as current authority.

7. Document metadata

Controlled documents must maintain, where applicable, a document identifier, title, version, effective date, lifecycle status, owner/domain, and supersession relationship.

Related documents

All controlled enterprise policies, standards, SOPs, and work instructions.